

110	Lopez vs. CH Robinson Company, Inc. 2022-01259258	Motion for Preliminary Approval of Class/PAGA Settlement The Court has reviewed the supplemental materials provided by Class Counsel and finds that with minor exceptions, they adequately address the previously identified issues. Accordingly, Plaintiff Javier Lopez’s Motion for Preliminary Approval of Class Action and PAGA Settlement is CONDITIONALLY GRANTED, pending submissions of a further declaration by counsel attesting to the details of the concurrently pending case that may be impacted by this settlement. This is a putative class action and PAGA matter involving alleged Labor Code violations and unfair business practices. On 5/12/2022, Plaintiff Javier Lopez, individually and on behalf of all others similarly situated, filed a class action complaint against Defendant CH Robinson Company, Inc. (ROA #2.) On 7/13/2022, Defendant answered. (ROA #17.) On 9/9/2022, the Court took notice that Plaintiff’s separate PAGA action is a related case—i.e., Plaintiff’s separate PAGA action against the same Defendant: <i>Lopez vs. CH Robinson Company, Inc.</i>, Case No. 30-2022-01273893. (ROA #23.) On 10/19/2022, Defendant filed a motion to compel arbitration. (ROA #36.) On 1/20/2023, the Court partially granted the motion and compelled Plaintiff’s individual claim for waiting time penalties under Labor Code section 203 to arbitration, but stayed the remaining claims in this action, including the class action claim for waiting time penalties. (ROA #82.) On 2/10/2023, Defendant filed a notice of appeal of the Court’s order partially denying Defendant’s motion to compel arbitration. (ROA #86.) On 11/8/2024, the Court of Appeal affirmed in part and reversed in part. The appellate court “conclude[d] substantial evidence supports the trial court’s finding that Lopez is a transportation worker within the ambit of section 1’s exemption, following the two-step analysis in <i>Southwest Airlines Co. v. Saxon</i> (2022) 596 U.S. 450, 455–459 (<i>Saxon</i>). Because the FAA is inapplicable, [the appellate court] h[e]ld the individual reimbursement claim under Labor Code section 2802 is arbitrable.” (ROA #129.) Accordingly, the appellate court reversed “[t]he trial court’s order denying Robinson’s motion to compel arbitration as to Lopez’s individual reimbursement claim under Labor Code section 2802” and “remanded to the trial court to enter an order compelling Lopez to arbitrate this claim. In all other respects, the order is affirmed.” (<i>Id.</i>) In the meantime, on 2/28/2023, Plaintiff filed a demand for arbitration with the AAA, but the arbitration was stayed pending the ruling on Defendant’s appeal of the Court’s ruling on the motion to compel arbitration. The parties then agreed to extend the stay pending completion of a second day of mediation. (See ROA #140.) The parties participated in two mediations on 4/2/2024 and on 10/13/2025. (See ROA #145.) On 1/12/2026, the parties reported in a joint statement that they had settled the case. (ROA #150.)
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112	Jamal vs. DB Global, Inc. 2024-01396853	Motion for Preliminary Approval of Class/PAGA Settlement Plaintiff Rima Jamal’s Motion for Preliminary Approval of Class Action and PAGA Settlement is further CONTINUED to November 5, 2026, at 2:00 p.m. in Department CX102. On 6/11/2026 at the first hearing on this motion, the Court identified various issues for class counsel to address, including (1) various issues with the settlement agreement’s terms, (2) various issues with the proposed class notice and proposed order, (3) the parties’ failure to formally consolidate the PAGA and class action cases as required by the terms of the settlement agreement, and (4) class counsel’s failure to provide a complete valuation analysis. (ROA #83.) In that order, the Court also specified: Class Counsel must file supplemental papers addressing the Court’s concerns no later than sixteen (16) court days prior to the continued hearing date. Counsel must also provide redlined versions of all revised papers and an explanation of how the pending issues were resolved with precise citation to any revisions. A supplemental declaration or brief that simply asserts the issues have been resolved is insufficient and will result in a further continuance. (<i>Id.</i>) On 9/1/2026, counsel filed a “Second Supplemental Declaration” that attaches a copy of the parties’ amendment to the settlement agreement. (ROA